Conclusion

What I have presented in this book are just nuggets and anecdotes and not a comprehensive history of the nearly two-hundred-year journey of the Indian Railways, yet I am hoping it has given one a sense of the genesis, magnitude and the spread of the iron web in India.

Every Indian has probably undertaken a rail journey some time in his life and cannot forget the reverberating sounds of ‘Chai, chai’, the large window bars and the monotonous announcements at stations and the exhaustion and excitement of undertaking a train journey. The Railways have been an inseparable part of Indian journeys since its inception. The people stories, the social changes they brought about and the way the transporter has effectively touched every sphere of life right from the time the British ruled India to the days of our freedom struggle and from the days of India becoming a republic to today’s growth years, would all, individually, make different odysseys.

This book is a sincere effort to capture the flavours of those journeys through through anecdotes, tales and documented incidents, chosen randomly but with attributions and endorsements, wherever possible. And that is the reason the book has so many quotes, to maintain originality through a narrative. There might be some incident or development which may not have been captured in its entirety, since the book shares nuggets of information without prejudice. A few authenticated anecdotes may even be thought to be disputed but have been included for the readers’ pleasure, to maintain the flow after basic corroboration.

The aim is to chronologically weave the nuggets to give a sense of history, geography and even sociology of India and shows how deeply the